Multi-Disciplinary Fire Service And Law Enforcement Operations (JHAT)

Prepared by:
Orange County Fire Chiefs' Association
Orange County Fire Services
Operational Plan

I. INTENT

This policy establishes guidelines and suggested uses of a multi-disciplinary response capability comprised of any combination of a fire service Hazardous Materials Response Team(s) (HMRT), the Orange County Sheriff's Hazardous Devices Squad, or any one or more of the three primary law enforcement Special Weapons and Tactics (SWAT) teams. This capability is often referred to as a Joint Hazard Assessment Team or JHAT.

II. POLICY

A. Background

During criminal incidents involving the need for multi-disciplinary tactics, such as potential terrorist attacks or law enforcement-driven incidents involving hazardous materials, explosives/improvised explosive devices (IEDs) or fire, the Orange County fire service and law enforcement will be working closely together in unified command to resolve the incident. Operational level resources from the fire service HMRTs, the Sheriff's Hazardous Devices Squad and the three primary SWAT teams have all been equipped with compatible response equipment and have engaged in joint training in preparation for these events. The HMRTs, Hazardous Devices Squad and SWAT specialty teams have the capabilities to work effectively in most threat environments. Other agencies that may be part of the JHAT response include the FBI WMD Coordinator, OC Health Hazmat Section, 9th Civil Support Team and OCIAC.

B. Use of the Multi-Disciplinary Capability

Having specialty teams working in concert with one another is a capability that will provide unified command with the best actionable intelligence and provide the best options for the incident's resolution. There is no set combination of teams or staffing required, as each incident will have differing needs. An incident may require a SWAT team and the Hazardous Devices Squad, or an HMRT and the Hazardous Devices Squad. Regardless of the combination, all teams are trained to work together. Information that unified command can expect from the joint operational capability may include:

- Credibility of the threat and the strategic impact of the event (local, state, or national impact)
- Information on the type of hazard or agent present
- Recommended size of the perimeter, exclusion zones and evacuation distances

- Options for mitigation (HMRT), render safe procedures (Hazardous Devices Squad) and the control of active shooter(s) (SWAT)
- Patient viability/rescue potential
- PPE selection
- Resources needed
- Regulatory compliance (Assist with ICS 201 & 208)

This information will be critical in the development of an incident action plan (IAP) that considers all of the jurisdictional and disciplinary responsibilities. Options provided to unified command by the specialty team leaders (HMRT, Hazardous Devices Squad, and SWAT) will be agreed upon by all three team leaders prior to presentation to unified command.

C. ICS Organization

The JHAT members assemble to support the incident and may be used to help develop the IAP; they do not have incident command responsibility. The specialty teams work at the division/group level of ICS and would typically report to a branch director or the operations section chief. If established, HMRTs and the Hazardous Devices Squad may work within either a fire branch or a law branch depending on the situation. It is recommended that branch directors and operations section chiefs be familiar with specialty team operations.

D. Specialty Team Specific Roles

HMRT:

- Identify perimeters and control zones for chemical or biological agent incidents
- Provide support for SWAT and/or Hazardous Devices Squad personnel during entry operations
- Select proper PPE for JHAT entry and decontamination personnel. Provide support to entry personnel including pre and post entry medical monitoring
- Provide atmospheric hazard assessment and monitoring for JHAT entrants from a safe location as designated by JHAT haz mat group supervisor, the incident safety officer or JHAT law enforcement personnel. Based on monitoring results, reduce the size of the Hot Zone, when possible
- Perform rescue of victims in a contaminated environment
- Develop a decontamination plan for victims and entry personnel

- Control, minimize or mitigate the release of chemical, biological or radiological agents
- Develop a Site Safety and Health Plan for extended operations (ICS 208)
- Law enforcement personnel will make every effort to render areas clear prior to a HMRT entry

Hazardous Devices Squad:

- Determine credibility of bomb threats, investigate suspicious packages/devices
- Provide force protection for HMRT and SWAT personnel during entry operations
- Search buildings or areas for possible IEDs; reduce the size of the Hot Zone
- Render explosive devices safe
- Assist in victim rescue
- Post-blast investigation and collection of evidence at the scene

SWAT

- Law enforcement operations within contaminated atmospheres.
- Engage and eliminate active shooter(s)
- Provide force protection for HMRT and Hazardous Devices Squad personnel during entry operations (a minimum of two SWAT personnel will be attached and dedicated to HMRT and Hazardous Devices Squad entry personnel during an incremental entry into a tactical Warm Zone)
- Provide security for the incident perimeter and the ICP
- Rescue of hostages/victims

E. JHAT Resource Requests

Unified Command will designate a unified ordering point through each discipline (Fire & Law). Elements of the JHAT will be ordered through those unified ordering points. HMRTs will be ordered through the fire ordering point and the Hazardous Devices Squad and SWAT will be ordered through the law enforcement ordering point.

F. JHAT Training

Command staff for the JHAT agencies meet monthly and training occurs quarterly.

APPENDIX A

UNCLASSIFIED//FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

ORANGE COUNTY OPERATIONAL AREA JOINT HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCE THREAT ASSESSMENT PROCESS

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THREAT ASSESSMENT PROTOCOL

LAW ENFORCEMENT
First Responders

OR

FIRE DEPARTMENT
First Responders

STEP 1

CONDUCT INITIAL ASSESSMENT

SEE PAGE 2

STEP 2

REQUEST FOR APPROPRIATE RESOURCES

- OC BOMB SQUAD
- FIRE HAZMAT
- FBI WMD Coordinator
- OC Health Hazmat

(See page 3)

THREAT ASSESSMENT PROTOCOL

INITIAL ASSESSMENT FOR 1ST RESPONDERS

SUSPICIOUS PACKAGE – Any suspicious substance present?
- Powder
- Explosives
- Liquid
- Radioactive materials (PRD Alarm for non-medical)

YES

NO

THREAT – Expressed or implied threat to create fear?
- Written threat
- Actions
- Verbal threat

YES

NO

PEOPLE – Any individuals showing OR reported signs of symptoms?
- Difficulty Breathing
- SLUDGE: Salivation, Lacrimation, Urination, Defecation, Gastrointestinal Distress & Emesis
- Skin Irritation
- Loss of consciousness
- Burning, watering eyes

YES

NO

TARGET – A specific person or at a location? (not limited to)
- Place of worship
- Mass gathering site
- Health Care site
- Utilities
- Government site
- Defense Industry
- Transportation
- Any high profile site
- Special Event

YES

NO

INTELLIGENCE – Have had prior or similar incident occurred?
- At the same location
- Prior training bulletin
- At like locations
- Prior Intelligence briefing (person of interest)

YES

NO

MAKE NOTIFICATION ISOLATE & WAIT

"NO or NOT OBSERVED" TO *ALL* 5 Questions:
NO THREAT
RELEASE SCENE TO RESPONSIBLE PARTY

"YES" to *ANY* of the Questions:
MAKE NOTIFICATION TO SPECIAL TEAMS, ISOLATE AREA & WAIT FOR UNITS TO RESPOND
(SEE PAGE 3)

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THREAT ASSESSMENT PROTOCOL

SPECIAL TEAMS NOTIFICATION

Units Arrived On-Scene
OCSD BOMB SQUAD
FIRE HAZMAT

WMD Incident

- Any threatening note or action to the target, individual, or institution?
- Intelligence from LAW/FBI

NO

Drugs Related

- Intelligence/Info from LAW
- Presence of Drugs
- Drug making materials/equipment
- Overdose injury or death

YES

WMD NOTIFICATION

1. **OCIAC**
   (714) 289-3949
2. **FBI WMD Coordinator**
   LA-WMDC@fbi.gov
3. **OC HEALTH HAZMAT**
   (714) 824-9953

YES

DRUGS NOTIFICATION

Bomb Squad (714) 538-2694

- **MAKE notification to OCCLEAN**

Fire Hazmat/Health Hazmat

- **An unknown substance with exposure to personnel or the public dictates further action is required based on a risk assessment (further action includes but does not mandate action such as further Reconn., sample obtaining field testing a public safety field, etc.**

If no exposure exists nor a life threat – action should be **stopped** for LEA/RNSP for evidence collection and OCHCA decontamination

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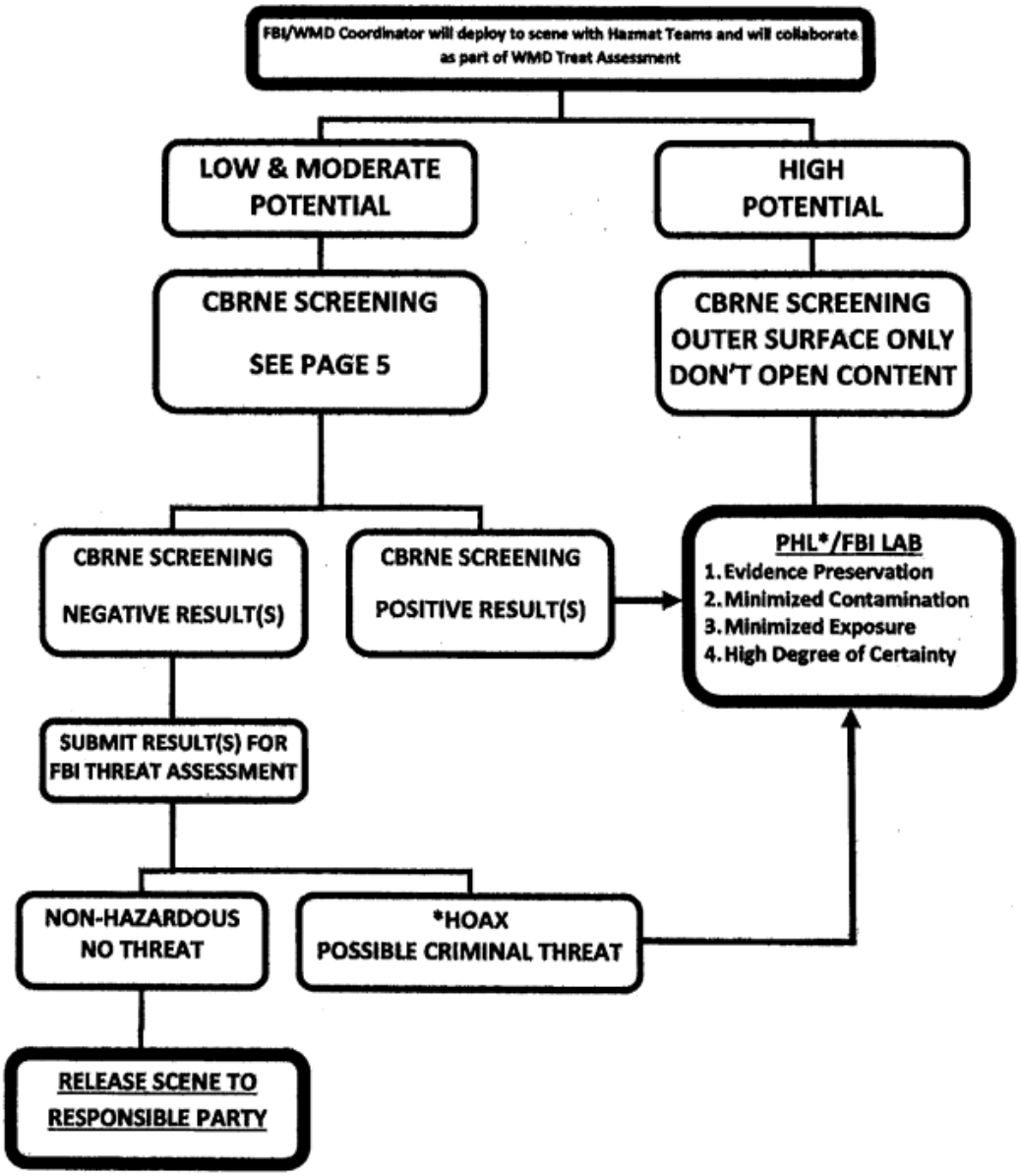
THREAT ASSESSMENT PROTOCOL

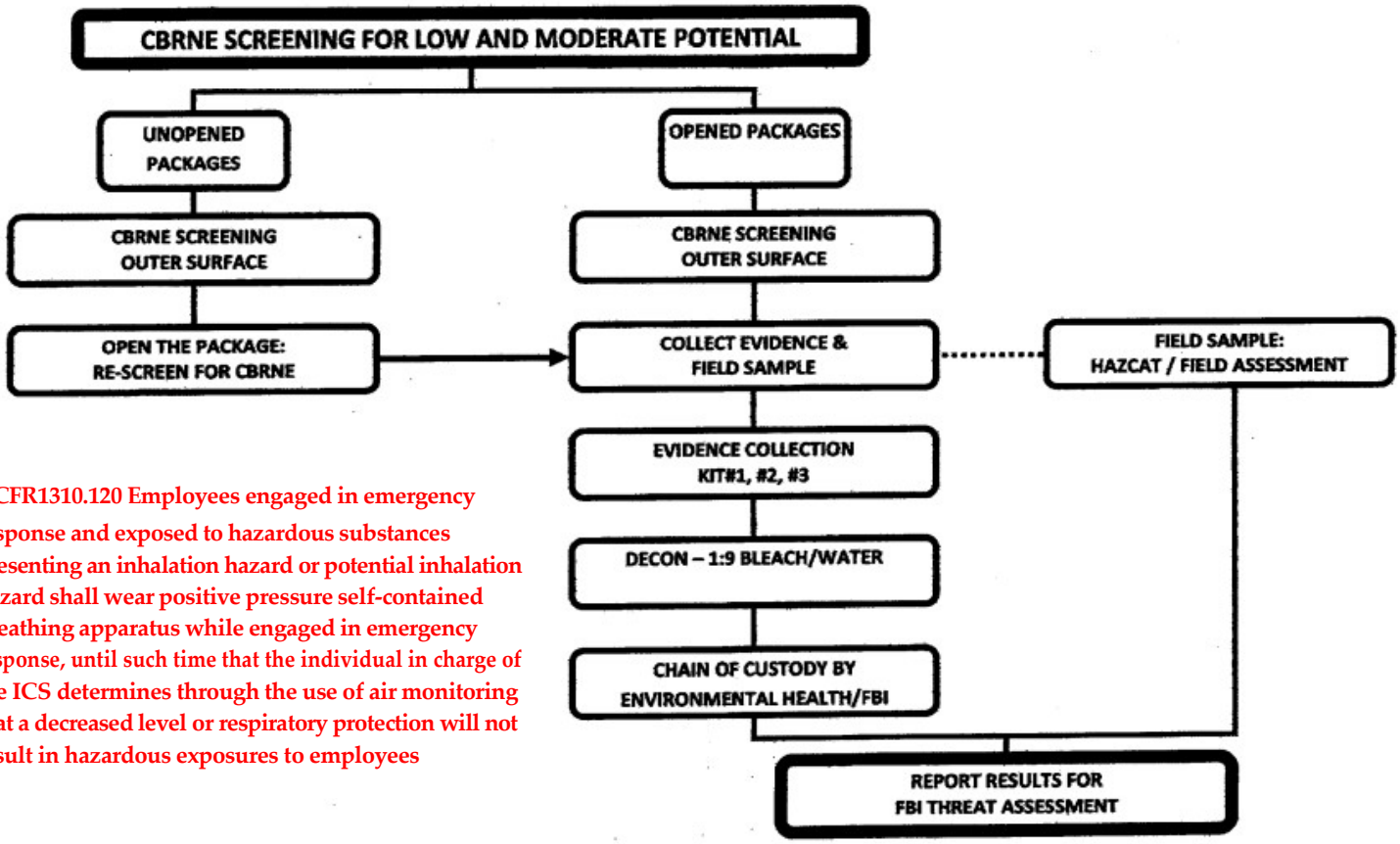
FBI THREAT ASSESSMENT



*Evidentiary sample is transported to the Orange County Public Health Laboratory for biological screening.

THREAT ASSESSMENT PROTOCOL

ENTRY TEAM CBRNE SCREENING PROCEDURES



*CFR1310.120 Employees engaged in emergency response and exposed to hazardous substances presenting an inhalation hazard or potential inhalation hazard shall wear positive pressure self-contained breathing apparatus while engaged in emergency response, until such time that the individual in charge of the ICS determines through the use of air monitoring that a decreased level or respiratory protection will not result in hazardous exposures to employees

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